

Saturday, February 16, 2008

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FASTBREAK

How the Top 25 fared in boys basketball

- Garfield Heights (19-1):** Defeated No. 18 Strongsville, 89-75. **Next:** Plays Maple Heights / Nondonia winner Friday.
- St. Edward (15-4):** Defeated No. 16 Euclid, 75-57. **Next:** Hosts No. 18 Strongsville tonight.
- Mentor (16-3):** Idle. **Next:** Hosts Warren Harding tonight.
- Glenville (18-2):** Idle. **Next:** Plays Shaw on Tuesday.
- Archbishop Hoban (17-3):** Lost to No. 7 Villa Angela-St. Joseph, 56-53. **Next:** Plays Louisville / Northwest winner Feb. 23.
- Firestone (17-3):** Idle. **Next:** Plays Akron North / Wooster winner Friday night.
- Villa Angela-St. Joseph (16-4):** Defeated No. 5 Archbishop Hoban, 56-53. **Next:** Plays Cleveland MLK / Cardinal winner Friday night.
- Cleveland Heights (15-5):** Idle. **Next:** Plays Twinsburg / Shaker Heights winner Friday night.
- Nordonia (16-4):** Lost to No. 17 Normandy, 67-59. **Next:** Plays Maple Heights on Monday night.
- Brunswick (14-5):** Lost to No. 22 Elyria, 54-39. **Next:** At Keystone tonight.
- Bedford (13-6):** Idle. **Next:** At Shaker Heights tonight.
- Benedictine (14-5):** Idle. **Next:** Hosts No. 15 St. Ignatius tonight.
- Barberton (15-4):** Defeated Highland, 73-61. **Next:** Plays Wadsworth / Hudson winner Feb. 23.
- St. Vincent-St. Mary (13-7):** Defeated Canton McKinley 74-68. **Next:** Plays Canton South / Coventry winner Friday night.
- St. Ignatius (12-7):** Idle. **Next:** At No. 12 Benedictine tonight.
- Euclid (12-7):** Lost to No. 2 St. Edward, 75-57. **Next:** At Admiral King tonight.
- Normandy (15-5):** Defeated No. 9 Nordonia, 67-59. **Next:** Plays North Royalton / Midpark winner Feb. 23.
- Strongsville (12-7):** Lost to No. 1 Garfield Heights, 89-75. **Next:** At No. 2 St. Edward tonight.
- Twinsburg (16-4):** Lost to Hudson, 63-53. **Next:** Plays Shaker Heights on Monday night.
- Kent Roosevelt (16-3):** Defeated Field, 69-43. **Next:** At Kenmore tonight.
- John F. Kennedy (14-6):** Idle. **Next:** Plays Field on Thursday.
- Elyria (14-6):** Defeated No. 10 Brunswick, 54-39. **Next:** Plays Westlake / Amherst winner Feb. 23.
- Tallmadge (14-6):** Defeated Wadsworth, 77-61. **Next:** Plays Revere / Chagrin Falls winner Feb. 23.
- Madison (16-4):** Defeated Harvey, 80-58. **Next:** Plays Chardon / Riverside winner Friday night.
- North Olmsted (15-5):** Lost to Olmsted Falls, 74-71. **Next:** Plays Medina / Strongsville winner Feb. 23.

GAME BALLS

Vote for Friday's top boys basketball performer at cleveland.com/tlr until noon Tuesday. See who won Thursday in The Locker Room. A Game Balls T-shirt will be mailed to the winning player's athletic director.

The contenders: Cody Apthorpe and Phil Workman, Windham Combined for 59 points, 23 rebounds and nine assists in a 89-83 victory over Woodridge.
Kyle Caiola, Normandy Senior point guard scored 21 second-half points en route to 35 total in a 67-59 win over Nordonia.
Promis Cabill and Demetrius Dalton, Elyria Senior guards combined for 32 points in a 54-39 win over Brunswick. Both hit two 3-pointers, and Cabill grabbed six rebounds.
William Felder, Lutheran East Junior forward had 35 points, 18 rebounds and four blocked shots in a 69-64 victory over Lutheran West.
Bryan Gregorich, Chardon Junior guard finished with 25 points, two assists and two steals in a 92-69 victory over Lakeside.
Tyler Harper, Solon Senior guard hit the game-winning 3-pointer as time expired in a 48-47 win over Stow. He finished with 24 points and three assists.
Chris Hudkins, Kent Roosevelt Senior center finished with 12 points, 12 rebounds and three assists in a 69-43 win over Field.
Rodney Munson, North Royalton Junior guard drained six 3-pointers and finished with 20 points in a 65-44 win over Parma.
Andrew Revella, Mayfield Junior forward led the Wildcats with 29 points in a 78-71 overtime win over Valley Forge. He also had five rebounds.

BOYS BASKETBALL

Same old Bulldogs up to same old tricks

MIKE PETICCA
Plain Dealer Reporter

Some things change.
Garfield Heights' boys basketball team played in the Lake Erie League Erie Division last season, and in the Northeastern Ohio Conference Valley Division this season.
Some things remain the same.
The Bulldogs won championships both seasons, sharing the LEL Erie title with Bedford a year ago, and clinching the NEDC Valley with Friday night's 89-75 home win over Strongsville.
"We preach conference and state championships," Garfield Heights coach Sonny Johnson said as the Bulldogs cut

down the nets following a prolific performance that featured Carl "Lay" Jones and Robert Wilson. "Even my first year, when we were 12-9, we preached that. That's what you play for."
Garfield Heights, ranked first in The Plain Dealer's seven-county poll, finishes the regular season 19-1, 9-1 — its lone loss to Brunswick, 69-68, last Friday. Johnson, Ohio's Mr. Basketball as a Bulldogs senior in the 1997-98 season, is in his third year as coach and has a 39-4 record the last two seasons.
Jones, a 5-10 junior guard averaging 25.5 points, scored 32 points on 13-of-22 field-goal shooting, including

4-of-7 on 3-point shots. Wilson, a 6-5 senior guard-forward and Wisconsin recruit, scored 26 points and grabbed 14 rebounds. He made 10 of 16 shots and showed his versatility by hitting 2 of 3 3-pointers and making three dunks. The final throw-down came off an alley-oop pass from Anthony Stuplight.
Garfield Heights ran for 36 fast-break points.
The Bulldogs netted eight 3-pointers and scored off drives to the basket, offensive rebounds and medium-range jumpers.
"It's fun, the best feeling," Wilson, averaging 18.5 points, said of the Bulldogs' offensive prowess. "It just takes teamwork. When we do things the way we're

supposed to, we click."
Strongsville (12-7, 5-5), ranked 18th, had a six-game winning streak snapped. Senior Tim Kamezye, a 6-5 forward with a 26-point scoring average, tallied 29 points. Freshman Aaron White, 6-5, added 11 points.
"We had a lot of trouble defending back, off their rebounds and deflections," Mustangs coach Joe Lynch said. "Offensively, we didn't get too many good looks."
Garfield Heights used a 19-6 run, including 11 points by Jones, to boost its lead to 78-53 early in the third quarter.

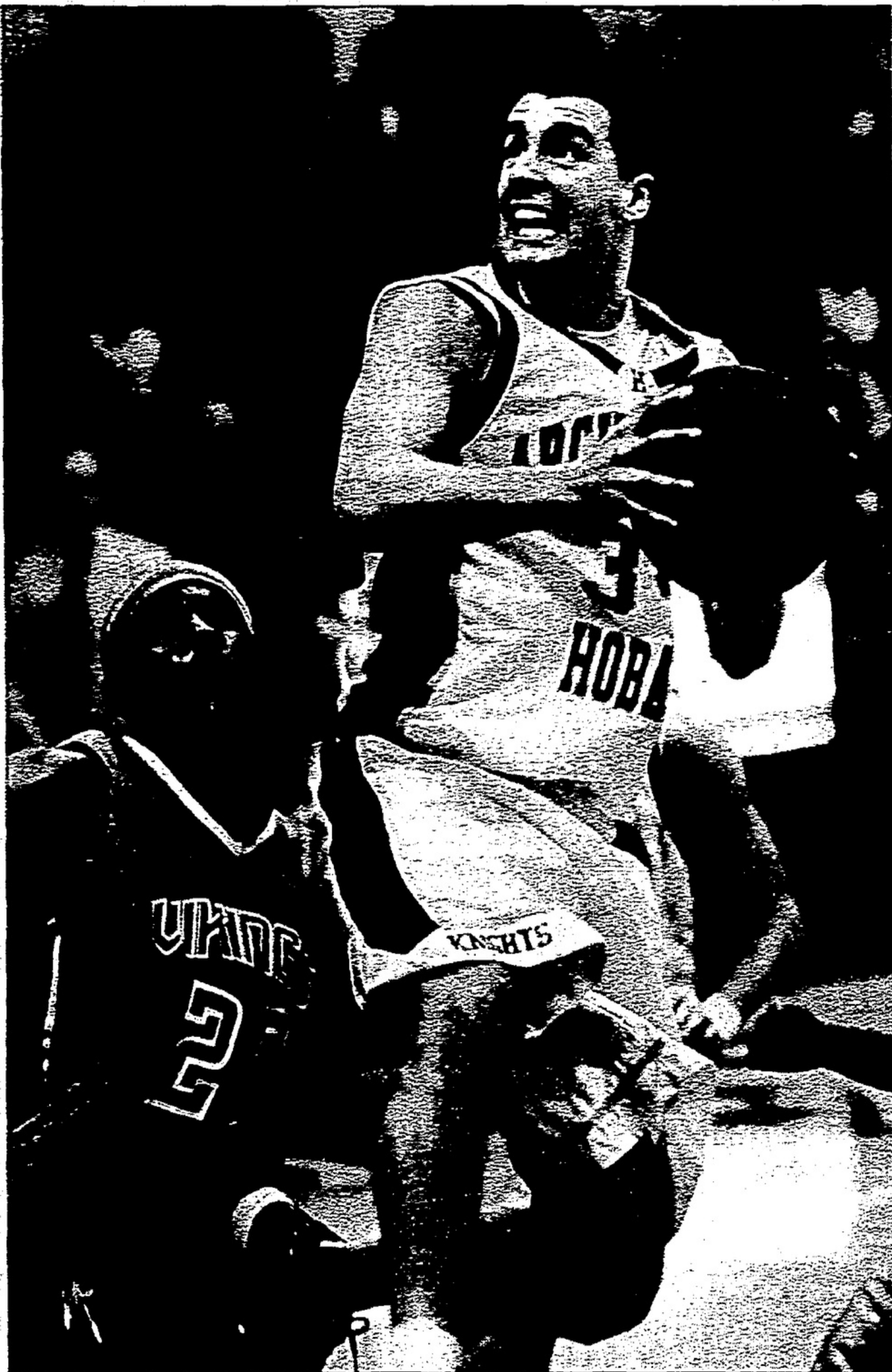
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Postseason appetizer

Vikings outlast Knights in taut playoff warm-up

TIM ROGERS
Plain Dealer Reporter

Villa Angela-St. Joseph coach Dave Wojciechowski said he couldn't think of a better pretest for the upcoming postseason and he loved the outcome.
Archbishop Hoban coach T.K. Griffith said just about the same thing, the end result notwithstanding.
Both teams put themselves through the ringer — not to mention the fans who packed Hoban's tiny Barry Gymnasium — on Friday in a season-ending game that was fitting for two teams with high expectations for the postseason.
VASJ, ranked seventh in The Plain Dealer and seventh in the final Division III state poll, withstood a frantic fourth quarter and came away with a hard-earned 56-53 victory that snapped Hoban's winning streak at 17.
"I think this was the first time all season that we held together and did the things we were supposed to do in the fourth quarter," said Wojciechowski, whose team improved to 16-4 and opens tournament play Friday. "It was a great way to get ready, winning against a very good team that is very well coached and had everything going for it on Senior Night. I am extremely proud of the way our kids hung in there."
Hoban, ranked fifth in The Plain Dealer and 11th in the final Division II state poll, fell to 17-3. But, Griffith was not complaining.
"Believe it or not, I really feel this will be good for us going into the sectionals," he said. "VASJ has some incredible athletes and they play hard. And, you couldn't have asked for a better environment."
VASJ senior Ashen Ward found the environment to his liking, especially in the fourth quarter. The 6-4 guard scored nine of his 16 points — including two 3-pointers — and two of his four rebounds over the final eight minutes when the Vikings rallied from a four-point deficit.
"The fourth quarter was the kind of thing we've been practicing for all season," said Ward, who redeemed himself for two earlier misses by making three free throws in the final 13.6 seconds, including a pair that extended VASJ's lead to the final 3-point margin with 11.2 seconds left. "We



Archbishop Hoban's Mitch Dorfman, right, heads to the basket while VASJ's Ashen Ward (20) defends during the Vikings' 56-53 win Friday in Akron.

wanted to get better in the fourth quarter as a team and get ready for the tournament. We did that and hopefully it will carry us through."
Ward, who shared team and game scoring honors with teammate Nate Barnes, also came up with a major rebound when he grabbed his second miss at the foul line with 13.6 seconds left and was fouled again.
"Ashen has been doing that all year," said Wojciechowski. "His (scoring) numbers might be down a little bit from last

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HIGH SCHOOL ROUNDUP

Normandy upends No. 9 Nordonia

From staff reports

Kyle Caiola scored a game-high 35 points, and Josh and Jordan Ebinger combined for 15 more as Normandy, ranked No. 17 in The Plain Dealer Top 25, upset No. 9 Nordonia, 67-59, in a Northeast Ohio Conference Lake Division boys basketball game.
The Knights (16-4, 9-1) tied the game at 38 late in the third quarter, but the Invaders (15-5, 8-2) ended the period with a 6-0 run. Caiola, who scored 21 points in the second half, also made 12 of 14 free throws, and Ronnie Malaga added 10 more points for Normandy.
Holy Name 59, Padua 31 Senior guard Johnny McGoun scored 16 points, including four 3-pointers for the Green Wave (13-6, 8-5 North Coast League Blue Division).
Avon 64, Bay 62 Avon junior guard Marquis Harrell's two free throws tied the game at 62 in overtime, and junior post Garrett Gronowski's tip-in with less than a second left was the difference for the Eagles (12-8, 8-6 West Shore Conference). Kyle Banal and Pat McGlynn combined for 28 points for the Rockets (8-12, 6-8).
Solon 48, Stow 47 Senior guard Tyler Harper's fourth 3-pointer of the night with less than four seconds to play was the difference for the Comets (8-12, 5-5 Northeast Ohio Conference River Division).

Harper led all scorers with 24 points, and junior guard Kyle Goudy added 13 more. Sophomore guard Blake Williams led the Bulldogs (11-9, 6-4) with 17 points, including five 3-pointers.
Olmsted Falls 74, No. 25 North Olmsted 71 The Bulldogs (13-7, 12-2) swept the series with the Eagles (15-5, 11-3) and won the Southwestern Conference behind senior guard Jim Brabenec's game-high 25 points. Senior center Pat Pellerite scored 19 of his 21 points in the second half, and junior forward Scott Kimmey added 18 more for Olmsted Falls.

No. 2 St. Edward 75, Euclid 57 Senior forwards Tom Pritchard and Andy Stainbrook combined for 27 points, and Conor Tilow and Justin Staples each scored 10 for the Eagles (15-4). Senior guard LaBryant Abercrombie led Euclid (12-7) with 13 points.

Lutheran East 69, Lutheran West 64 William Felder had 35 points, 18 rebounds and four blocked shots for the Falcons (14-6). Scott Voiers led the Longhorns (16-4) with 28 points.

No. 22 Elyria 54, No. 10 Brunswick 39 Demetrius Dalton and Promis Cabill combined for 32 points and four 3-pointers for the Pioneers in the Northeast Ohio Conference Valley Division.

Cleveland Central Catholic 57, Elyria

Catholic 40 Louis Hinson had 20 points and seven rebounds, and Brandon Campbell added 19 points and five steals for the Ironmen (14-6, 9-4 North Coast League White Division).

Fairport 59, Cuyahoga Heights 53 Danny Ward scored 25 points and Aramis Greenwood had 22 for the Skippers (14-6) in the Chagrin Valley Conference Metro Division. Zach D'Orazio led the Redskins (5-15) with 17 points and 12 rebounds.

Swimming and diving
Northeast Ohio District Championships Bay sophomore Nikki Craft set a state record (502.80) in the Division II girls district diving championships at Cleveland State's Busbey Natatorium on Thursday. Strongsville diver Rachel Rosenberg was tops in Division I (467.70), followed by Firestone seniors Bethany Haver (423.90) and LeeAnna Hoover (419.10). St. Ignatius' Chad Carmichael finished first among boy divers (484.25).
Solon boys and girls swam best in Division I on the first day of district events at CSU, where Comets senior Alisa Vereshchagin won the 200-meter free (1:53.17) and senior Tommy Inwood won the 200 individual medley (1:52.19). Hawken leads among Division II girls, where senior Brittany Strumbel won the 200 free (1:51.01), junior Brittany Rospierski won the 200 individual medley (2:07.09), and freshman Alana Arnold finished first in the 100 fly (58.44).

Pirates' blemishes don't hide perfection

TIM WARSINSKEY
Plain Dealer Reporter

Derek Dawson's face spoke volumes for the Perry Pirates — the big bump and a small cut under his left eye combined with the wide grin — it was the look of a champion.
Dawson's gritty play off the bench, scoring seven of his 12 points in the fourth quarter, sparked Perry's boys basketball team to a 55-46 victory over visiting Kenston and completed an unusual feat in the Chagrin Valley Conference.
Many at Perry have been pointing toward 2008-09 as the Year of the Pirates in the CVC because of a talented junior class. This group, however, has proven the future is now.
Perry has pulled the rare double of winning a football co-championship in the big-school Chagrin Division, and then winning the boys basketball title with a 10-0 record. The Pirates had a new head coach in each sport and were anything but preseason favorites.
"I don't think many people thought we were going to win the CVC in football and basketball, or even be that good for that matter," said Dawson, one of three seniors on the basketball team and a tight end in football. "It means a lot. It's a tough league, and the juniors did a big part in both sports."
Dawson said there was no way Perry (16-3, 10-0) would overlook Kenston (14-6, 7-3) even though the league title was wrapped up a week ago.
"It was a big game because we knew we already had the CVC, but not very many teams have won all 10 games," he said. We wanted people to know that, no matter what, we're the best team — undisputed."

Dawson, a 6-2 forward, frequently guarded 6-7 Chris Meyer and 6-4 Cory Barton, which led to an inadvertent elbow to Dawson's face. Perry's other key senior, point guard Kevin Siegel, scored a game-high 23 points. Perry's third senior, Caleb Siegel, is out with a broken leg.
In what had been a tight and intense game — tied at halftime and at the end of the third quarter — Dawson scored five points during a 9-0 run that gave Perry a 47-39 lead with 4:10 remaining.
Kenston still was in it late. Trailing, 51-46, with 52 seconds left, Bombers guard John Behm registered his fifth steal, but Kenston missed a wide-open 3-pointer and a putback. A subsequent foul on Kenston after a non-call on a Kenston miss inside led to coach Josh Jakacki getting a technical foul. Siegel made four straight free throws.
"That was the difference there," Jakacki said. "That was a big play."
Barton and backup guard Teddy Long led Kenston with 11 points each.

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